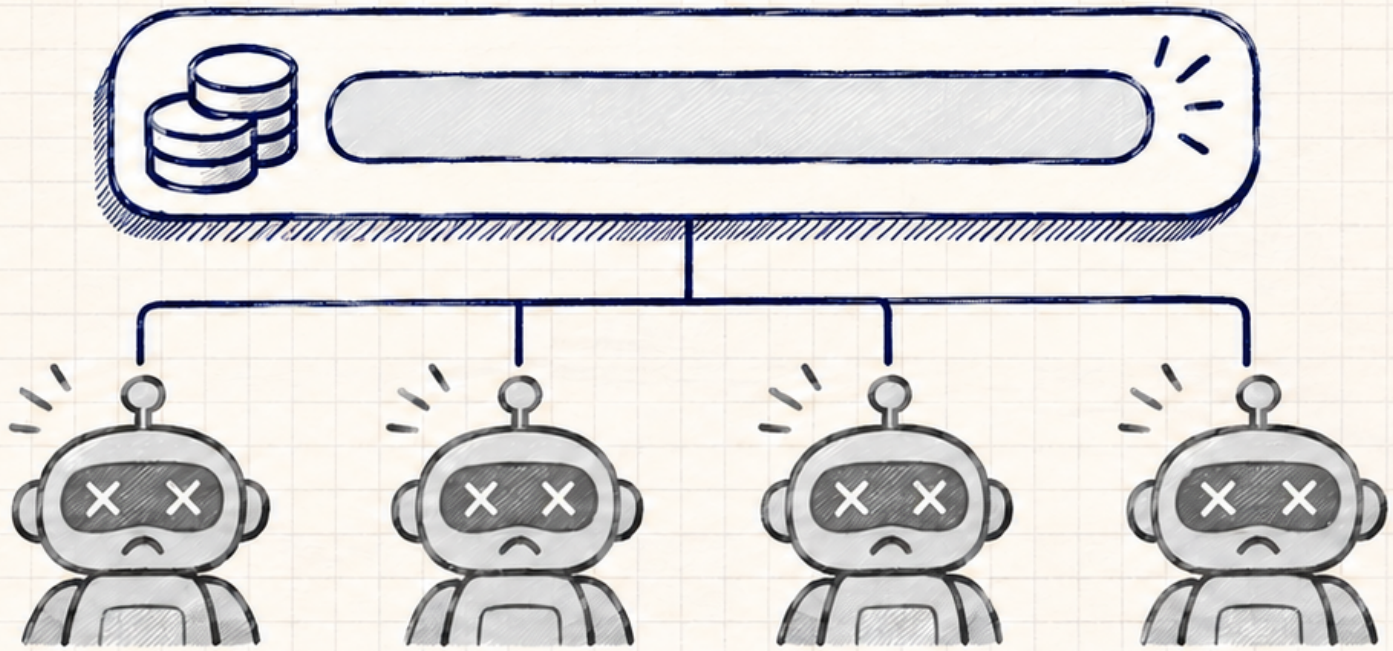
How our AI gateway works

A small working example of "governance follows the work", the idea in Human Driven AI's AI Routers Are Changing AI Governance.

One limit stopped everything

On 14 October 2026 every AI agent here shared one spending limit. It ran out, and all of them stopped at once.

One shared limit

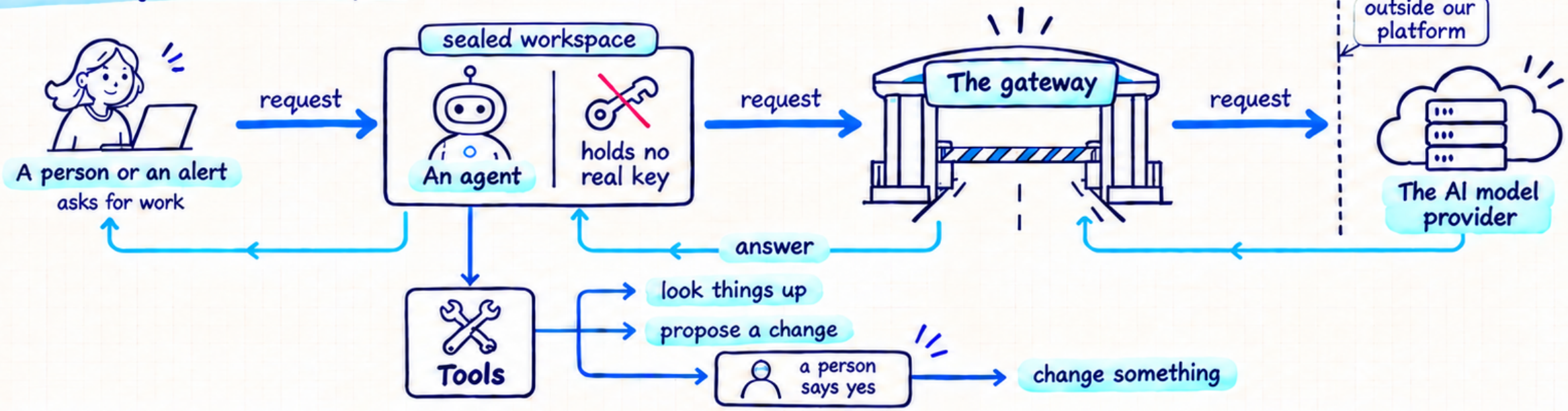


So each group of agents got its own daily limit, enforced at one checkpoint.

The pathway

Every model request takes this one path.

For the ten groups shown here.



What the gateway checks

1. **Who is asking?**
   Each group of agents is recognized by its own pass.
2. **Is this model approved for them?**
   Each group has a short list of models it may use.
3. **Is there budget left today?**
   Each group has its own daily limit.

Only now does the gateway add the real key and send the request on.



Recorded for every request: which group, which model, how much it cost.

Not recorded: the question or the answer.

Kept 30 days.

When a group's budget runs out

- **80% used:** a warning goes to the owner.
- **100% used:** that group's requests are refused until midnight (UTC).
- Every other group keeps working.



daily limits from $0.50 to $10 per group

Match the model to the work, and keep a person on the risky steps

The right size of model for the job

Looking things up, simple suggestions → a smaller, cheaper model.



Investigating problems, writing fixes → a more capable model.



People choose the model for each agent in advance, in a reviewed file. The gateway does not choose; it only refuses a model that is not on the list.

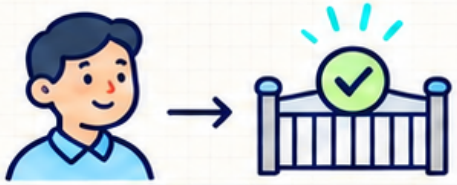
Three kinds of action, one needs a yes



Read: look at information. No approval.



Propose: draft a change for a person to accept or reject. No approval to draft; a person must accept it before anything changes.



Change or delete: waits until a named person approves that exact action. The decision is recorded.

The rules are written down

The limits and lists live in one reviewed file. Changing one is a change request someone approves. There is no override switch.

What we share with the article

- [x] Governance follows the pathway, not a list of tools.
- [x] Policy is a technical control, not a reminder to be careful.
- [x] We started with a real problem, then chose the technology.
- [x] Smaller models for simpler work.
- [x] A person approves high-risk actions.

What we chose not to build yet

- A router that picks the model per request.
- Scanning requests for sensitive information.
- Switching to a second provider if the first is down.
- One provider, one small platform: these were not our problem yet.